

Heritage Healed

As we seek sanctuary from our hyper connected lives, Ayesh Baganbari in Kolkata stands as a testament to the art of slow living

By **MONICA KHOSLA BHARGAVA**

Photographs by **PHOTOGRAPHIX INDIA**

This isn't just a renovation; it is a love letter to the Baganbari—the quintessential Bengali country house born from 19th century colonial elegance. When I acquired this 1.5-acre property in Barasat in 2006, the gardens were a wild tangle and the 1,650 sq ft structure was crumbling. Yet, the soul of the place was unmistakable. Named 'Ayesh' (meaning relaxation) in 1967 by the legendary filmmaker Satyajit Ray, who shared a bond over Western classical music with the original owner, Dr. Adi Gazder, the home was built for the very purpose of unwinding. My mission was to decode its architectural DNA and reset it for a contemporary lifestyle.